

SOUTHERN PREVIEW

PELS BANKING ON ROOKIE BRIGADE

By BOB ROESLER

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NEW ORLEANS, April 5 (AP) — If you could get a look at Andy Cohen's New Orleans Pelican lineup for opening day against the Mobile Bears, you probably would see question marks at first, third, shortstop, catcher and the mound.

For Cohen, the former New York Giants infielder, the well-worn gag, "Who's on first?" isn't a laughing matter.

The Birds have been training at Huntsville, Texas, with about 50-odd prospective players going through the paces. And if a half dozen of them stick around for opening day on April 10, Cohen will have migraine headaches.

Of course, he just might have to go to the post with a wet-behind-the-ear lineup, for Joe L. Brown, general manager of the parent Pittsburgh Pirates, recently said the Pels shouldn't expect any help from the Bucs.

"You'll have to depend," warned Brown, "on your help coming from our Hollywood (Coast League) farm. As it



Andy Cohen



Johnny Powers



Ray Swarts



Larry Gilbert

stands now, the pitchers and outfielders with us will be around for a while."

About the only near-ready spot is in the outfield. Back for another shot with the Pels is Johnny Powers, who played half of the '55 season with the Pels and the other half with Williamsport, where he hit .309.

Also back is Ray Swarts, who played centerfield here last year.

Swarts, however, may be asked to play third base this year, because there just isn't another third sacker in camp.

The third outfield candidate is Emil Panko, who came to

spring camp heralded as a home run producer. But after a few weeks temperamental Emil packed his bags. Someone lured him back into camp and he's been performing well.

At first base is promising, but untested Dutch Van Burkleo.

Earl Weaver, who was the sparkplug of last year's infield, has the second base job all to himself. Dick Barrone looks like the shortstop. Dave Jacobs is the utility man.

Lenny Yochim and Don Urquhart comprise the pitching

staff. Yochim won a dozen games last year as a Pel. Urquhart, used mostly in relief, quit the team at midseason and went into retirement. Len is on the injured list at camp but Don has been doing extremely well. One of the two will open against the Bears.

Harry Fisher, pinchhitter par excellence a few years back, is back in camp as a pitcher-outfielder. He also figures to be Cohen's No. 1 pinch hitter.

Another big change in the Pelican operation is their new general manager, Vince Rizzo, former scout for the Chicago Cubs. Rizzo was Pel GM during the prosperous years that followed World War II.

Another new addition is Larry Gilbert, one of the league's outstanding managers and front office men. Larry, who was part owner of the Nashville Vols until last season, returns to the club he helped win many pennants in the 1930's. He's on the board of directors and will serve in an advisory capacity.